

NIGERIA — WEEKLY THREAT BRIEF

Nigerian Military Counter-Insurgency Operating Environment

Reporting period: 14 – 21 September 2026 (7 days) | Issued: Monday 21 September 2026. A quieter week in volume but a clean one in pattern. ISWAP came at two Borno forward operating bases on consecutive nights and lost the exchange both times: FOB Gajiram on 17 September, detected early by MNJTF ISR and broken up with close air support, and FOB Mairari the same night, contained with further close air support for four enemy dead. A third attempt on Gajiram on 18 September was also repelled. There was no strike-package-and-BDA story this week — the air contribution was on-call close air support and casualty evacuation, which is the tasking an air unit will actually be asked for. The documentary detail behind the 10 September US C-17 delivery emerged: the associated FMS case names 1,002 MK-82 bombs and 5,000 APKWS II rounds, A-29 compatible, into Kainji. Background from the baseline assessment and earlier issues is not repeated.

1. Bottom Line Up Front

- Two Borno FOBs attacked on the same night, both held with close air support — and a third attempt the next day. Multi-source.** On 17 September terrorists advancing on FOB Gajiram in Nganzai LGA were detected early by Multinational Joint Task Force ISR assets; troops adopted defensive measures, the OPHK Air Component provided close air support, and the attackers withdrew into adjoining areas without closing. Later the same night several ISWAP fighters assaulted FOB Mairari in Guzamala LGA and met, in the official phrasing, robust close air support; four bodies were recovered on exploitation along with an AK-47, 25 rounds of PKT, an RPG bomb, two magazines and a camcorder. Wounded troops were stabilised and airlifted. On 18 September a further attempted infiltration of FOB Gajiram was repelled by troops, air assets and quasi-security forces. The Commander Sector 3 conducted a post-engagement assessment and both positions were reinforced. This is confirmed by the OPHK statement (Capt Mohammed Goni, 18 September) and carried independently by Vanguard, Voice of Nigeria, PRNigeria, Daily Nigerian, The Authority and NAN. For an air unit this is the week's whole lesson in one incident: the request that comes is close air support on a base under night attack, not a planned strike, and the detection that buys the time comes from somebody else's ISR — in this case MNJTF's.
- The air contribution this week was CAS and CASEVAC, not interdiction — a different tasking profile from the last fortnight.** There was no Tumbunma-Baba-style deliberate strike with a battle damage assessment in open reporting this window, and the recommended re-attack on the Tumbuns has not surfaced. What the air component was doing instead was holding over two FOBs under attack, breaking up a third approach, and moving casualties. Read against the previous two issues, the theatre's air effort has swung from the deliberate to the reactive inside a fortnight. Plan crew rest, alert states and arming for on-call night CAS in the Nganzai–Guzamala–Kukawa belt rather than for a strike cycle, and assume casualty evacuation will be requested in the same sortie window. The absence of an interdiction story is not evidence the interdiction stopped — it may simply not have been announced under a new theatre commander still setting his release policy.
- The paperwork behind the 10 September C-17 is now public: 1,002 MK-82 bombs and 5,000 APKWS II rounds, A-29 compatible, into Kainji.** TruthNigeria on 16 September tied the AFRICOM C-17 delivery at Lagos and Kainji to State Department congressional notification 21-47 of 13 August 2025, which lists 1,002 MK-82 500-pound general-purpose bombs, 5,000 Advanced Precision Kill Weapon System II rounds and guidance kits, at roughly \$346 million. Whether those specific items were on that specific aircraft is not established and should not be assumed. What is reasonable to conclude is that a large tranche of A-29 Super Tucano-compatible ordnance has entered the Nigerian pipeline at Kainji. Two practical consequences: sortie rates and munitions expenditure by the fixed-wing strike fleet are likely to rise over the coming months, which raises the volume of air activity we share airspace with; and APKWS is a laser-guided rocket, so expect more laser designation in the same airspace we operate in. Same source reports that roughly 200 US personnel deployed to Nigeria this year have

relocated to a base in Cameroon with smaller trainer and intelligence teams remaining — single-source on the timing, but consistent with the separately reported US return to Salak/Maroua from June. If the MQ-9 presence at Bauchi has thinned, the ISR picture supporting the North East has changed and the question is worth asking through the chain.

- **ISWAP brought a camera to a base attack, and its photographer was among the dead.** The Mairari exploitation recovered a camcorder and the DHQ operational report of 19 September identifies one of the four dead as the group's photographer. A media operator inside an assault element is not incidental: it means the attack was being filmed for release, which tells you the operation was planned as an information product as much as a military act, and it means imagery of the base, its layout and any aircraft over it was being collected. Assume any FOB we operate into in that belt is being recorded from the outside during attacks, and assume that failed attacks still generate usable footage. It also means the absence of a published ISWAP video after this week is itself a small indicator — the media chain took a loss.
- **Sixteen weeks with nothing employed against aircraft; the week's threat signal is on the ground and in the Middle Belt.** No enemy drone use, no MANPADS, no AAA, no GPS or EW interference and no aircraft or UAV losses, checked again by search this week; the last confirmed airframe loss remains the 2 January CH-4 (technical, Kontagora). What did move: Plateau turned lethal again over the weekend of 19–20 September with nine killed across Barkin Ladi and Riyom, including five passengers shot on the Gana-Ropp road and a Baptist pastor killed on his way to church, and a 19 September intelligence alert warned of possible attacks on markets, churches and mining sites across the state. That sits on top of the 9 September Army-wide warning about coordinated attacks on churches, schools and NYSC camps. And on 13 September a large armed group assaulted the Operation BURST joint security base on the Igbeji axis in Oyo State, burning a patrol van and a building block — a deliberate attack on a fixed security installation in the South West, which is why Oyo is the single heatmap level change this issue.

2. North East Developments

Window note: a thinner week than the last two in raw volume, and clearer for it. The enemy's effort went into FOB attacks on the Nganzai–Guzamala axis in northern Borno rather than into MSR devices or the Mandara belt, and it failed three times. The surrender flow continued, including a commander. Nothing new surfaced this week on the reported JAS ceasefire, on the Mussa or Lassa schoolchildren, or on a re-attack in the Tumbuns.

FOB Gajiram and FOB Mairari, 17–18 September — three attempts, three failures

Detail as at Section 1. Three points worth extracting. First, the detection: the official statement credits MNJTF ISR assets with picking up the approach to Gajiram early enough for the garrison to posture before contact. That is a coalition sensor feeding a Nigerian garrison and then a Nigerian air response — the deconfliction and cueing chain worked, and it is worth understanding how that request flowed if we are ever the asset on station. Second, the sequencing: Gajiram was probed and the attackers withdrew without committing, then Mairari was assaulted the same night. Read as one operation, that looks like a feint or a shaping attempt at Gajiram and the main effort at Mairari — or an opportunistic switch after the first approach was spotted. Either way, an attack broken up at one FOB in this belt is a reason to raise alert at the neighbouring ones, not to stand down. Third, the return to Gajiram on 18 September, the day after failing there, shows the tempo the enemy is willing to sustain against a position it wants.

Gajiri-Giwa, Kukawa, 18–19 September — attack on farmers broken up

Troops of 19 Brigade detected terrorists moving on motorcycles towards Kauwa Primary School to attack farmers in the Gajiri-Giwa area of Kukawa LGA. The brigade's mobile strike team engaged them along the Cross-Baga axis and forced them to flee. One soldier and one farmer sustained

gunshot wounds and were stabilised at the 19 Brigade medical centre. Two details matter beyond the incident: the enemy is again targeting the farming population directly as the harvest window opens, which historically drives both displacement and the mass-casualty events that follow; and a brigade mobile strike team, not air, was the responder here — the ground quick-reaction option is being used where it can reach.

Surrenders — including a Qaid

On the night of 16 September two JAS terrorists, one of them a Qaid (commander), surrendered to troops of Sector 1 OPHK along the main supply route Miyanti–Darel Jamel in Bama LGA, bringing three AK-47 rifles, five magazines, a motorcycle and a cache of ammunition. They are in military custody undergoing profiling. A commander walking in with his weapons and his transport is a better indicator than a headcount of foot soldiers: it suggests either that the pressure on that sub-unit is real or that the reported Bakura-faction truce is producing defections at command level. Separately, troops rescued eight people and arrested six ISWAP members across Borno and Adamawa in operations reported on 14 September, at the start of this window. The theatre commander's public line after the FOB engagements was the standard call for those still in the bush to surrender through established channels.

The reported JAS ceasefire — no movement this week

Nothing new surfaced. There has been no government, Defence Headquarters or Army acknowledgement of The New Humanitarian's 7 September report of a three-month truce with the Bakura Doro faction, no confirmation of the expected 40-day extension, and no reporting either way on the warning that JAS may be using the lull to move equipment into the Mandara mountains. The targeting-policy question raised last week is therefore still open and still unanswered in open sources. Note in passing that the JAS Qaid who surrendered at Bama this week did so from a faction reportedly inside the truce, which cuts both ways as evidence.

Schools thread — day 129 and day 84

No release, negotiation or proof-of-life reporting surfaced this window for the Mussa pupils (taken 15 May) or the 36 Lassa students and one staff member (taken 29 June). Thirteen consecutive weeks without a public development on the Lassa cohort.

3. Air / ISR & Force-Protection Watch Items

- **Plan for on-call night CAS in the Nganzai–Guzamala–Kukawa belt.** Three FOB attacks in two nights, all met with close air support, all in the same northern Borno corridor. That is the tasking pattern to be postured for: alert aircraft able to get overhead a base already in contact, at night, with the ground commander controlling. It is a different problem from the deliberate interdiction the theatre was running a fortnight ago — shorter notice, less planning time, higher risk of friendly-force proximity, and a requirement for confident night identification of a perimeter under attack.
- **Somebody else's ISR is cueing the defence.** MNJTF ISR assets detected the approach to Gajiram. Understand that feed: who holds it, what its coverage windows over the Nganzai–Guzamala axis are, and how a cue from it reaches an aircraft. If our ISR is tasked into that belt we are working alongside, not instead of, an MNJTF picture — and the reverse is the useful case, where an MNJTF detection is the thing that generates our launch.
- **Casualty evacuation was part of the tasking, not an afterthought.** Wounded troops at Mairari were stabilised and airlifted; the Gajiri-Giwa casualties were treated at the 19 Brigade medical centre. Expect a CASEVAC request in or immediately after any FOB defence sortie in this belt, and know in advance which receiving facilities are being used and what the night

landing situation is at each. The 44 Nigerian Army Reference Hospital helipad at Kaduna, commissioned in August, remains the reference for the North West chain.

- **The MK-82 / APKWS tranche means more fixed-wing activity and more laser in the airspace.** A thousand general-purpose bombs, guidance kits and five thousand laser-guided rockets into the A-29 fleet at Kainji implies a higher fixed-wing sortie rate and more munitions expended over the coming months, in the same North East and North West airspace we transit. APKWS is semi-active laser guided: designation activity will increase, with the usual implications for anyone operating optics or DIRCM-adjacent equipment in the same block. None of this changes deconfliction procedure, but it changes the volume of traffic that procedure has to handle.
- **Watch item — has the US ISR footprint at Bauchi thinned?** The reported relocation of about 200 US personnel to Cameroon, with trainers and intelligence specialists remaining, is single-source on timing but plausible against the independently reported US return to Salak/Maroua from June. If the MQ-9 presence that arrived at Bauchi around March has moved with them, the ISR available to the North East fight has changed materially and so has the airspace picture over Bauchi. This is a question to ask through the chain rather than infer: what is still flying from Bauchi, and who deconflicts it.
- **Enemy media operators are inside assault elements.** A camcorder was recovered at Mairari and the dead included the group's photographer. Assume base attacks in this belt are being filmed, that aircraft overhead are in frame, and that footage of failed attacks still gets used. Two practical effects: imagery of our airframes, tail numbers and patterns may be collected at FOBs we operate into; and any future ISWAP release showing an aircraft over a base should be treated as a propaganda product with a known collection date, not as evidence of a new capability.
- **Threat systems: nothing employed — sixteen weeks.** No enemy drone use, no MANPADS, no AAA, no GPS or EW interference, no aircraft or UAV losses. The last documented armed-drone use against a Nigerian base remains Sabon Gari, Damboa (late January 2026); the last confirmed airframe loss remains the 2 January CH-4 (technical failure, Kontagora). The Kadiya anti-aircraft rounds (29 August, single-source) remain uncorroborated. Standing background is unchanged: the February 2026 reporting of about 35 drones moved to ISWAP through the Lake Chad corridor, unemployed to date. An RPG bomb was recovered at Mairari — RPG remains the realistic low-level threat to rotary aircraft in this theatre and the one weapon the enemy demonstrably has in quantity.
- **Force protection on the ground: the threat alert is against soft targets, and it has started producing.** The 9 September Army intelligence alert warned of coordinated attacks on churches, schools and NYSC orientation camps across the North East, North West, North Central and parts of the South West, with ISWAP reportedly reconnoitring targets and fighters moving from Katsina through Kaduna towards Plateau. On 13 September a security base was attacked in Oyo; on 19 September a Plateau-specific alert named markets, churches and mining sites; on 19–20 September nine people were killed in Barkin Ladi and Riyom. Off-duty movement, church attendance and any routine pattern of life at fixed locations in Plateau and the North West should be reviewed against that. Treat the NYSC camp element as live: those are fixed, announced, densely populated sites.
- **Information environment.** This week produced a clear example of the recirculation problem. Zagazola's breaking-news index surfaced, as apparently current, the killing of Brig Gen Musa Uba (November 2025), an ISWAP drone recovery at Izge (December 2025), the Kasuwan Daji massacre and the Niger State attacks that killed 42 (January 2026), a 69-strong MNJTF surrender (July 2024) and the Maiduguri mosque-bombing arrests (December 2025 – March 2026). All were checked and excluded. The operating rule stands and now has a second clause: treat any loss, shoot-down or casualty claim involving air assets as unverified until

confirmed through the chain, and check the publication date of anything that arrives without one.

4. Other Theatres in Brief

- **South West — a security base was attacked in Oyo, and it is the week's one heatmap change.** Between about 05:30 and 06:00 on Sunday 13 September a large armed group stormed the Operation BURST joint security base on the Igbeji axis of Oorelope LGA, Oyo State, opening fire with heavy weapons and setting fire to a patrol van and a building block, both destroyed. The attack was repelled after the command mobilised personnel from sister agencies and the attackers fled into surrounding forest. Attribution has not been confirmed by any authority; it follows a published alert on suspected Boko Haram movement in Oyo and the 9 September Army-wide warning of fighters moving south from Katsina through Kaduna. A deliberate assault on a fixed security installation in the South West is a different category of event from the rural kidnapping that has characterised Oyo, which is why the state goes 2 → 3 with its terrorism sub-level raised from 0 to 2 while banditry/kidnapping remains the dominant type. Treat the jihadist attribution as unconfirmed.
- **Middle Belt — Plateau lethal again, and pre-warned.** Between Saturday night 19 September and Sunday morning 20 September at least nine people were killed across Barkin Ladi, Riyom and neighbouring communities. Five were passengers travelling to Gana-Ropp in Barkin Ladi, shot when gunmen opened fire on a Vectra heading to Mangu — four passengers and the driver killed, one survivor. A Baptist church pastor and one other were killed on their way to church at Dorowa Babuje on Sunday morning. A woman was killed at Baten Wereng in Riyom and another person at Ratyidi in Fan District. Reported totals run nine to ten depending on outlet. This came two days after a 19 September intelligence alert warning of possible attacks on markets, churches and mining sites across the state. Dorowa Babuje is the same location where Berom militia attacked herders on 9 September — the axis is cutting both ways. Plateau holds 4 on the heatmap.
- **North West — no new air story this week, and the prior week's Police Air Wing operation is the current reference.** Nothing surfaced inside this window to match the previous week's Yankuzo air operation or the Police Air Wing strikes across Katsina and Zamfara that killed nine and recovered a rocket launcher with warheads and three PKMs (reported 13 September, at the edge of the last window). The standing point holds regardless: at least three air operators work the North West — NAF under Op FANSAN YAMMA, Army and joint assets, and the Nigeria Police Air Wing — and the Police Air Wing must be in the deconfliction picture for any tasking or transit across that airspace. Vanguard reported troops capturing terrorist commanders in Katsina and rescuing victims in Kaduna and Katsina during the window; a reported peace accord in Katsina released 45 kidnap victims, which is a political arrangement worth watching for the same reasons as the Borno truce.
- **South East — quiet in reporting; levels hold.** No IED, camp raid or contact was reported inside the window in Anambra, Imo, Abia, Enugu or Ebonyi. Imo and Anambra hold 3 on the August–early-September pattern, including the 4 September anti-armour IED on the Orsu axis carried in the last two issues.
- **Niger Delta / Gulf of Guinea — fifteenth consecutive quiet week for militancy.** No new pipeline or maritime attack claims. The Army's 18–19 September operational report records Joint Task Force South-South, Operation DELTA SAFE arresting two suspected oil thieves in Rivers — one at Ndoni Junction with 19 bottles of illegally refined kerosene, another on the Okwuzi–Mgbede–Ebocha axis with 34 sacks of illegally refined automotive gas oil. Routine economic-crime interdiction, not militancy. Elsewhere in the same report, Operation WHIRL STROKE with the NDLEA arrested 12 suspected drug peddlers at Mararaba Udege in Nasarawa.

- **Regional.** No new regional command change inside this window. The standing picture is unchanged from last week: Niger's armed forces command was reshuffled on 11 September for regime security rather than counter-terrorism, cross-border deconfliction on the Nigeria–Niger seam should not be assumed to function, and every neighbour on the northern arc is looking inward. No gubernatorial changes in Nigeria this week.

5. Country Activity Heatmap (last 3 months)

The two views below summarise assessed security activity across all 36 states and the FCT over roughly the last three months ($\approx$ late June – 21 September 2026). The choropleth shows each state's dominant incident type (fill colour) and intensity (shade depth and number); the matrix breaks activity down by incident type. This is an indicative qualitative assessment for orientation — synthesised from open-source reporting, not a counted event dataset such as ACLED. ONE level change this issue: Oyo 2 $\rightarrow$ 3, with its terrorism sub-level raised from 0 to 2 while banditry/kidnapping remains the dominant type, on the 13 September assault on the Operation BURST joint security base at Igbebi — a deliberate attack on a fixed security installation in the South West, with heavy weapons and arson, rather than the rural kidnapping that has driven Oyo's level until now. Attribution is unconfirmed, which is why the terrorism sub-level rises but the dominant type does not change. Everything else holds. Borno holds 4, reinforced (FOB Gajiram and FOB Mairari attacked on 17 September and a third Gajiram attempt on 18 September, all repelled with close air support; the Gajiri-Giwa attack on farmers broken up 18–19 September; a JAS Qaid surrendered at Bama on 16 September). Plateau holds 4, reinforced (nine killed across Barkin Ladi and Riyom on 19–20 September; a 19 September state-wide alert on markets, churches and mining sites). Adamawa 3, Yobe 2, Benue 4, Sokoto 4, Zamfara 4, Katsina 4, Kaduna 3, Niger 4, Kebbi 3, Kogi 3, Anambra 3, Imo 3, Kwara 2, Delta 2, Rivers 2, Edo 2, Jigawa 1 and Osun 1 all hold. Noted but not levelled: routine Op DELTA SAFE illegal-refining arrests in Rivers, Op WHIRL STROKE drug arrests in Nasarawa, and an armoury destruction in Taraba whose date could not be firmly established.

Nigeria Activity Heatmap — Geographic View (assessed, last ~3 months)
Indicative qualitative assessment as of 2026-09-21 — not a counted incident dataset

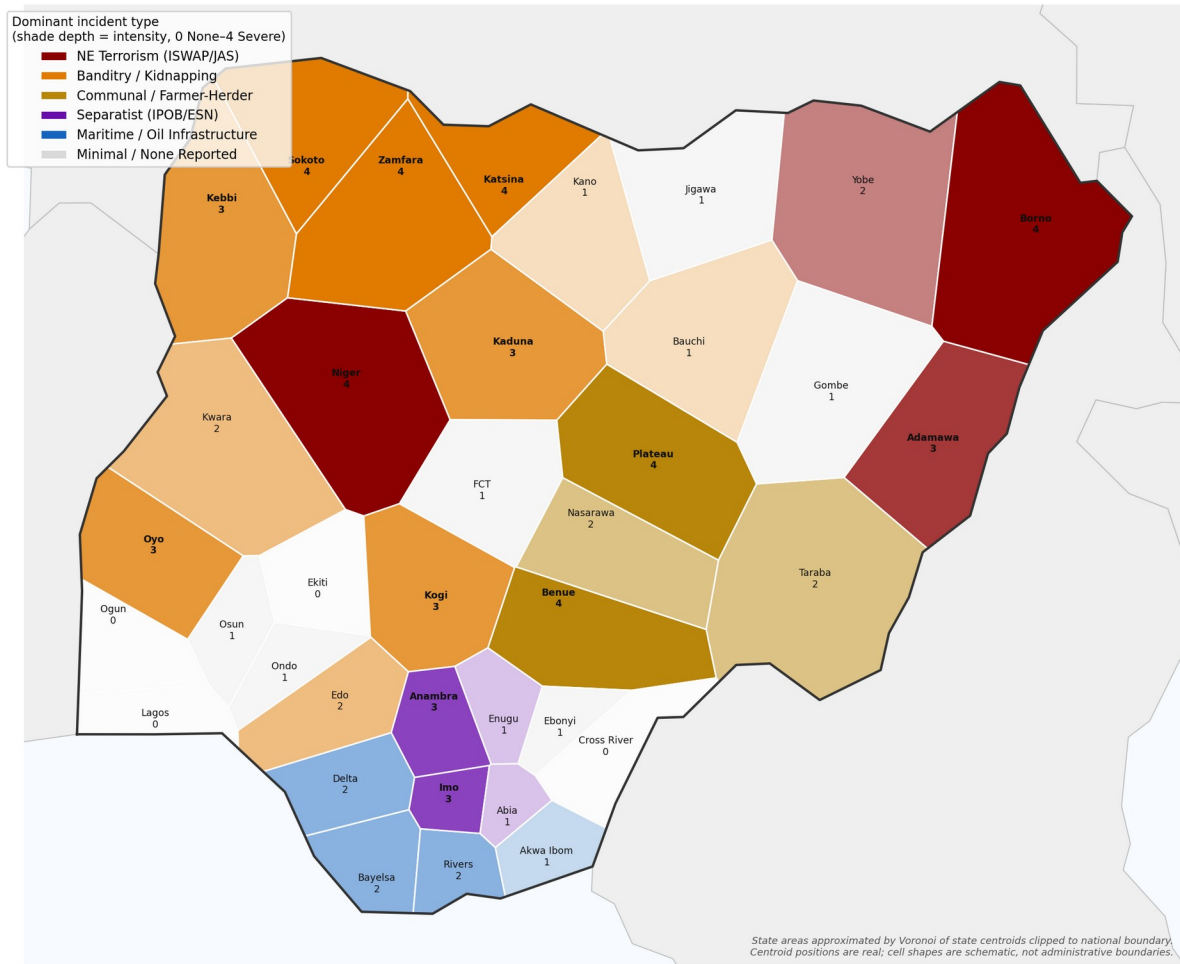


Figure 1 — Activity choropleth on a Natural Earth basemap (Nigeria + neighbours). Fill = dominant incident type; shade depth & number = intensity (0 None–4 Severe). State areas are approximated by Voronoi of state centroids clipped to the national boundary — centroid positions are real, cell shapes schematic. Indicative qualitative assessment, not a counted dataset.

Nigeria Activity Heatmap — Incident Type by State (assessed, last ~3 months)
States grouped by geopolitical zone — indicative qualitative assessment as of 2026-09-21, not a counted dataset

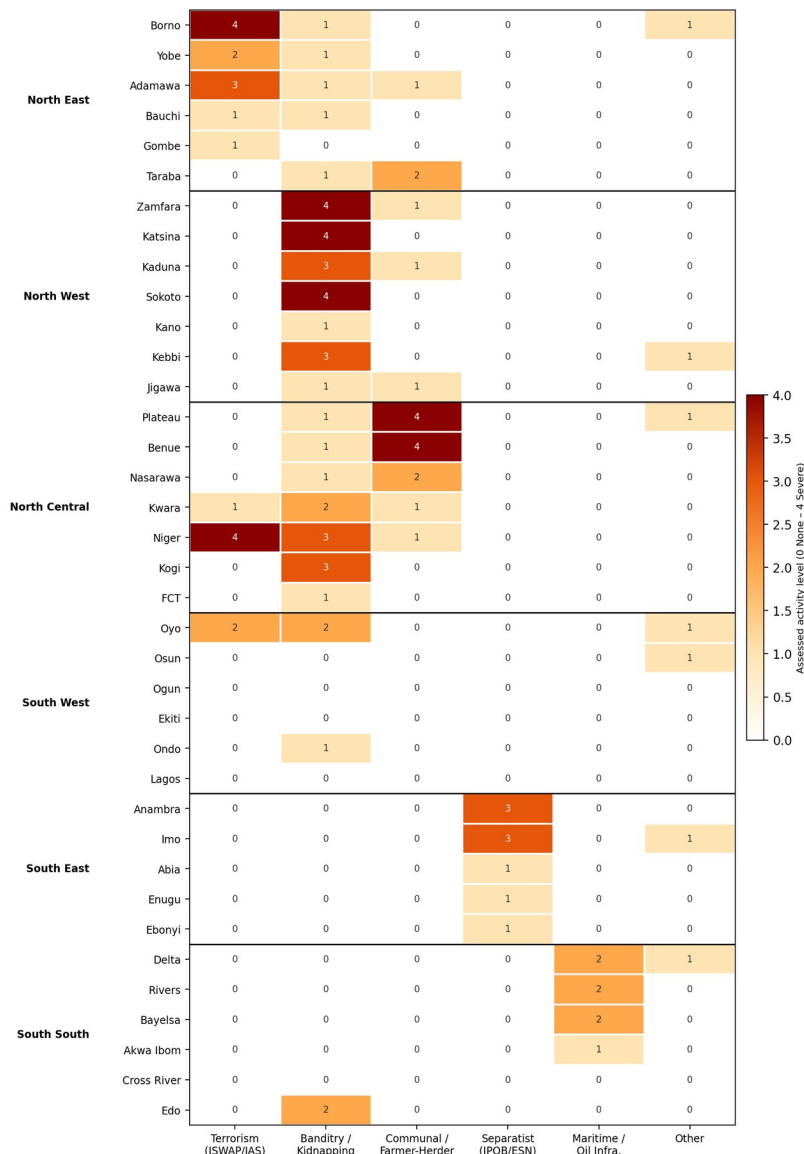


Figure 2 — Incident type by state (states grouped by geopolitical zone). Cell value/shade = assessed activity level, 0 None–4 Severe. Indicative qualitative assessment, not a counted dataset.

6. Events Map — UCDP (curated) & GDELT (news-derived)

Two-panel figure rendered this morning, 21 September, with GDELT ingested through 20 September. LEFT PANEL: a new UCDP release has landed, and the lag has closed sharply. The most recent seven days of curated data are now 25–31 August 2026 — 40 events and 188 best-estimate fatalities, 39 of them civilian — up from the 25–31 July window (29 events, 174 fatalities) that had been frozen for three weeks. The lag is now roughly three weeks rather than six and a half. Two things follow: the left panel is now close enough to be useful as a pattern check on early September, and the jump in recorded fatalities is partly a data-release artefact, not purely an escalation. Read it as verified late-August pattern, not as this week's ground truth. RIGHT PANEL: news-derived GDELT events for the actual last seven days (14 – 20 September 2026: 364 machine-coded events from about 4,044 articles, deduplicated and cross-checked against UCDP) — essentially flat on last week's 377 events, but from markedly more articles (4,044 against 3,465), which indicates heavier press coverage of a similar number of distinct events rather than more violence. GDELT is timely but noisy: locations and event types are machine-extracted and

individual dots are not verified incidents. Cross-referenced against Sections 1–4, expect clusters on the Nganzai–Guzamala FOB belt and Kukawa in northern Borno, Bama, a dense Plateau signature across Barkin Ladi, Riyom, Mangu and Bokkos, Logo in Benue, the Katsina–Zamfara axis, and a new and unusual South West signature around Oorelope in Oyo. Read the panels together: UCDP for verified pattern, GDELT for current tempo and geography.

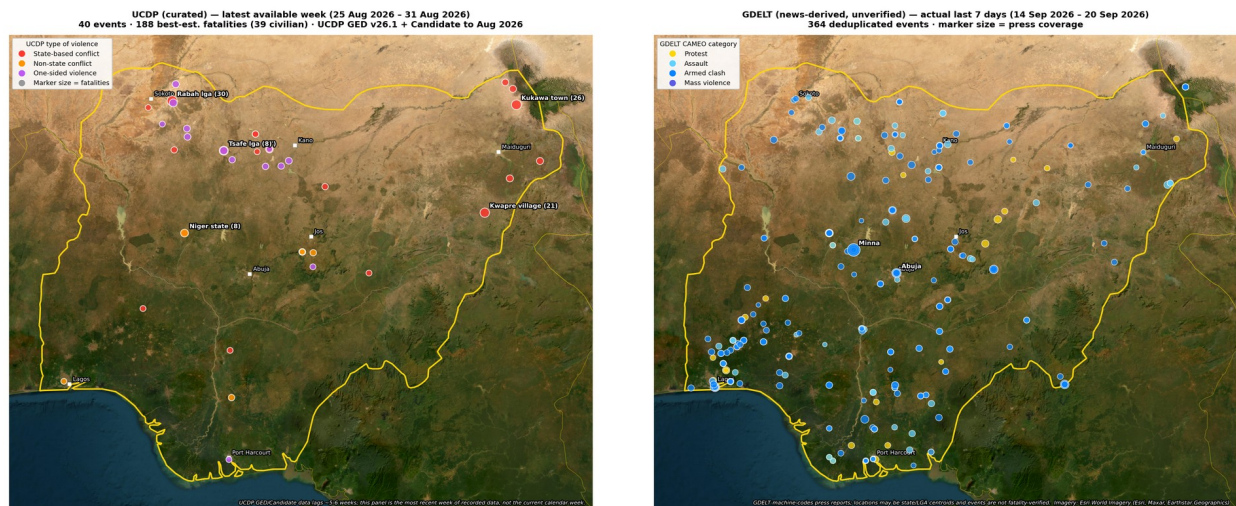


Figure 3 — Left: UCDP-recorded conflict events, most recent 7 days of available curated data (25–31 August 2026; 40 events, 188 best-estimate fatalities, 39 civilian; lags ~3 weeks — NOT current-week ground truth). Right: GDELT news-derived events for 14–20 September 2026 (364 events from ~4,044 articles) — machine-coded from press reporting, deduplicated, unverified; indicative of current reporting tempo only. Rendered 21 September 2026 from the daily-updated Nigeria Events Map.

[Interactive map \(republished daily\): https://rbmgloball.github.io/nigeria-events-map/](https://rbmgloball.github.io/nigeria-events-map/)

7. Sources

Open-source reporting consulted 21 September 2026. Military and government figures are flagged as claims throughout. Multi-source this window: the 17–18 September FOB Gajiram and FOB Mairari attacks and the 16 September JAS Qaid surrender (the OPHK statement of 18 September carried independently by Vanguard, Voice of Nigeria, PRNigeria, Daily Nigerian and The Authority, with additional detail from the Army's 18–19 September operational report via NAN/PM News — the two accounts agree on four dead, weapons recovered and the camcorder, and the operational report adds the photographer identification and the second Gajiram attempt on 18 September); the Plateau killings of 19–20 September (Vanguard, Tribune, Daily Trust, Pulse — totals run nine to ten); and the 10 September US C-17 delivery (AFRICOM, Vanguard, Daily Trust). Single-chain and so labelled: the FMS content detail and the reported US relocation to Cameroon (TruthNigeria, 16 September, resting on the State Department congressional notification for the munitions list and on unattributed sourcing for the relocation timing); the Igbebi base attack attribution; and the Katsina peace-accord release of 45 victims. RECIRCULATED ITEMS CHECKED AND EXCLUDED — an unusually large crop this week, all surfaced as apparently current on aggregator index pages: the killing of Brig Gen Musa Uba (November 2025); the ISWAP drone recovery at Izge (December 2025); the Kasuwan Daji massacre and the Niger State attacks that killed 42 (January 2026); the 69-strong Boko Haram surrender to MNJTF (July 2024); the Maiduguri mosque-bombing arrests and the naming of Shariff Umar (December 2025 – March 2026); ISWAP attacks on the Maiduguri–Damaturu transmission line (2022 and 2024); the appointment of Lt Gen Waidi Shaibu as Chief of Army Staff (October 2025); the Sambisa/Darajamal coordinated strikes (September 2025); and the CFR Nigeria Security Tracker weekly update for 12–18 September, which is from 2020. The Gubio convoy attack was covered in the 7 September issue and is not repeated.

North East — the FOB attacks, surrenders and operational reporting

- [Troops foil attacks in Borno, kill four terrorists \(18 Sep 2026\)](#) — *Vanguard* (full OPHK statement, Capt Mohammed Goni: FOB Gajiram detected by MNJTF ISR with OPHK close air support; FOB Mairari assaulted the same night, four dead, camcorder recovered, wounded airlifted; JAS Qaid surrender 16 Sep on MSR Miyanti–Darel Jamel)
- [Operation HADIN KAI Foils Attacks on Two Borno FOBs](#) — *Voice of Nigeria* (independent carriage of the same statement)
- [Troops Repel Terrorist Attacks on Borno FOBs, Eliminate 4, Recover AK-47s, RPG Bombs \(18 Sep 2026\)](#) — *PRNigeria*
- [2 JAS terrorists, commander surrender as Operation Hadin Kai foils attacks in Borno](#) — *Daily Nigerian*
- [Troops repel terrorist attacks on Borno bases, recover weapons as JAS Commander surrenders \(18 Sep 2026\)](#) — *The Authority*
- [Troops smash drug peddlers, oil thieves, terrorists in nationwide operations \(19 Sep 2026\)](#) — *PM News / NAN* (Army operational report 18–19 Sep: Gajiri-Giwa attack on farmers broken up by 19 Bde mobile strike team on the Cross-Baga axis, one soldier and one farmer GSW; Mairari exploitation identifies the group's photographer among the dead; second FOB Gajiram infiltration attempt repelled 18 Sep; Op DELTA SAFE oil-theft arrests in Rivers; OPWS drug arrests at Mararaba Udege)
- [Troops foil terrorist attacks in Borno, recover four bodies, weapons \(18 Sep 2026\)](#) — *PM News*
- [Troops rescue eight, nab six ISWAP members in Borno, Adamawa offensives \(14 Sep 2026\)](#) — *PM News* (start of window)
- [EXCLUSIVE: Nigerian government and Boko Haram strike secret ceasefire deal \(7 Sep 2026\)](#) — *The New Humanitarian* (standing reference; no development this week)

Air, ISR, munitions & US posture

- [U.S. Hands Nigerian Military Thousands of Bombs \(16 Sep 2026\)](#) — *TruthNigeria* (ties the 10 Sep AFRICOM C-17 delivery at Lagos and Kainji to State Dept congressional notification 21-47; 1,002 MK-82, 5,000 APKWS II, guidance kits, ~\$346m, A-29 compatible; also reports ~200 US personnel relocated to Cameroon with trainers and intelligence specialists remaining — relocation timing single-source)
- [Nigeria 21-47 congressional notification \(13 Aug 2025\)](#) — *US Department of Defense / DSCA* (primary document behind the munitions list)
- [US delivers military equipment to Nigeria \(Sep 2026\)](#) — *Vanguard* (C-17 delivery under an existing FMS case)
- [US sends fresh consignment of military equipment to Nigeria \(Sep 2026\)](#) — *Daily Trust* (independent chain)
- [U.S. Forces return to Cameroon, prioritizing ISR \(Jun 2026\)](#) — *Military Africa* (Salak/Maroua; corroborates the destination, not this month's timing)
- [US deploys 100 soldiers to Nigeria as attacks by armed groups surge \(Feb 2026 — standing reference\)](#) — *Al Jazeera* (original deployment; grew to ~200 with MQ-9s reported at Bauchi from around March)
- [Nigeria loses CH-4 drone \(Jan 2026 — standing reference, NOT current\)](#) — *Military Africa* (last confirmed airframe loss; technical failure near Kontagora)
- [ISWAP terrorists acquire more drones, plan coordinated attacks on Nigerian troops \(Feb 2026 — standing background\)](#) — *Premium Times* (~35 drones; unemployed to date)
- [9 bandits neutralised as Police Air Wing raids camps in Katsina, Zamfara \(13 Sep 2026\)](#) — *PRNigeria* (edge of the previous window; the standing reference for Police Air Wing activity in the North West deconfliction picture)

Threat warning, Plateau & the South West

- [ALERT: Nigerian Army Warns of Possible Coordinated Terrorist Attacks on Churches, Schools and Youth Camps \(Sep 2026\)](#) — *TruthNigeria* (Army intelligence alert dated 9 Sep; ISWAP reconnaissance reported; fighters moving Katsina–Kaduna–Plateau)
- [Terrorist Attacks Surge Across Nigeria as Army Issues Red Alert for Coordinated Strikes \(14 Sep 2026\)](#) — *TruthNigeria* (weekly roundup; includes the 13 Sep attack on the Operation BURST base at Igbeti, Oyo)
- [Bandits attack Oyo security base, torch patrol van \(Sep 2026\)](#) — *Punch* (independent chain on the Igbeti attack)
- [Security Alert: Intelligence Warns of Possible Attacks on Markets, Churches and Mining Sites Across Plateau \(19 Sep 2026\)](#) — *TruthNigeria*
- [Fresh Plateau attacks: Pastor, 8 passengers killed \(21 Sep 2026\)](#) — *Vanguard*
- [9 killed in fresh Plateau attacks \(21 Sep 2026\)](#) — *Daily Trust* (Barkin Ladi, Riyom; Gana-Ropp road vehicle attack; Dorowa Babuje; Baten Wereng; Ratyidi)
- [Baptist Church pastor, nine others killed in fresh Plateau attacks \(21 Sep 2026\)](#) — *Tribune* (higher total for the same nights)
- [BREAKING: Pastor, 7 Others Killed as Terror Attacks Erupt South of Jos \(21 Sep 2026\)](#) — *TruthNigeria*

North West & national

- [Troops capture terrorist commanders in Katsina \(Sep 2026\)](#) — *Vanguard*
- [Troops rescue 6 kidnapped victims in Kaduna, Katsina \(Sep 2026\)](#) — *Vanguard*
- [Military kill 12 terrorists, rescue 66 kidnapped victims in nationwide operations \(Sep 2026\)](#) — *Vanguard* (DHQ aggregate claim — unverified)
- [Zagazola Makama — breaking news index \(checked 21 Sep 2026\)](#) — *single-source chain for most granular theatre reporting; this week the index carried a large volume of recirculated 2024–early-2026 items with no visible publication dates (see exclusions above), so items were used only where a dated corroborating outlet existed*

Annex A — State Governors, Ethnic Affiliation & Principal Army Formations

Standing annex — changes since the 14 September issue are summarised here. Researched this week: NO GUBERNATORIAL CHANGES, NO DEFECTIONS, NO NEW GOC APPOINTMENTS and NO CHANGES IN OPERATION DESIGNATIONS. The Chief of Army Staff remains Lt Gen Waidi Shaibu, appointed October 2025 — flagged because an aggregator index recirculated his appointment this week as though current. ONE CLARIFICATION: the new OPHK Theatre Commander, previously carried here as Maj Gen I. A. Ajose from the 9 September Army release, is named in full in this week's OPHK statements as Major General Ibikunle Ajose; the annex is corrected accordingly. He made his first public statements in post this week, commending troops, the MNJTF ISR team and aircrew after the FOB engagements and repeating the standing call for surrender through established channels. ONE FORMATION ADDED: 19 Brigade, operating in Kukawa LGA, northern Borno, whose mobile strike team broke up the Gajiri-Giwa attack on farmers along the Cross-Baga axis on 18–19 September and which runs its own medical centre — the first appearance of 19 Bde in this annex. Also confirmed in post this week: Commander Sector 3 OPHK, who conducted the post-engagement assessment at FOB Gajiram and FOB Mairari and ordered both reinforced; Sector 1 OPHK, which received the JAS Qaid surrender on the MSR Miyanti–Darel Jamel in Bama; and MNJTF ISR assets supporting Sector 3, which provided the detection that gave FOB Gajiram its warning. STILL OPEN from the 9 September release: the location and parent

division of the newly established 8 Brigade under Brig Gen M. S. Adamu, which has not been disclosed. The July 2026 divisional slate (Maj Gen Yakubu Yahaya, 9 Div Ilorin; Maj Gen C. R. Nnebeife, 10 Div Jalingo; Maj Gen Moses Gara, 5 Div Makurdi; Maj Gen Auwalu Mahmuda, 2 Div Ibadan; Maj Gen A. S. M. Wase, 1 Div Kaduna) is unchanged, as is the September brigade and garrison slate (Brig Gen M. S. Sule at 27 TF Bde Biu; Brig Gen I. Sule at 6 Div Garrison Port Harcourt; Brig Gen E. Azenda at 2 Div Garrison Ibadan). 83 Division remains APPROVED BUT NOT YET ESTABLISHED, headquarters designated Benin City, AOR Edo/Delta/Bayelsa, expected stand-up by December 2026, with the Edo–Delta siting contest unresolved; no movement this week. The successor to Brig Gen M. S. Sule at Special Task Force Op ENDURING PEACE in Plateau has still not been publicly named — three weeks open, and Plateau is the state where the security situation deteriorated this week. The Plateau OPEP / Op SAFE HAVEN naming overlap persists and the caution stands: treat the two names as one AOR when routing a request.

State	Governor	Party (changes)	Ethnic affiliation (as publicly reported)	Principal Army formation(s) in state (indicative)
NORTH EAST				
Borno	Babagana Umara Zulum	APC	Kanuri	HQ 7 Div & OPHK Theatre Comd (Maiduguri) — Theatre Commander Maj Gen IBIKUNLE AJOSE (full name confirmed in OPHK statements this week; appointed 9 Sep 2026, replacing Maj Gen A. E. Abubakar); OPHK Sector 1 (Bama axis — received the JAS Qaid surrender on MSR Miyanti–Darel Jamel, 16 Sep); OPHK Sector 2; OPHK Sector 3 (Kukawa/Monguno/Nganzai/Guzamala) incl. 101 Special Forces Bn — Sector Comd conducted the post-engagement assessment at FOB Gajiram and FOB Mairari, 17–18 Sep; NEW this issue: 19 Bde (Kukawa) with its own mobile strike team and medical centre; FOB Gajiram (Nganzai) and FOB Mairari (Guzamala) now named as attacked positions, both reinforced; 26 TF Bde Garrison; 212 Bn (Jere); 115 Task Force Bn (Askira-Uba); 29 Task Force Bde; 154 Task Force Bn (Ngamdu, Kaga); 25 Bde (Damboa); 82 Div Task Force Bn (Gwoza); 192 Bn (M) (Gwoza–Limankara); 152 Task Force Bn (Banki); 233 Tank Bn; 27 Task Force Bde (Biu, Brig Gen M. S. Sule); 81 Div Task Force Bn attached; MNJTF Sector 3 (Baga) — MNJTF ISR assets provided the detection at FOB Gajiram; NAF air component OPHK (Maiduguri) — WATCH: the Nganzai–Guzamala–Kukawa FOB belt after three attacks in two nights;

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				reported JAS ceasefire area (Ngoshe/Mandara) — strike-authority question still open and unanswered
Yobe	Mai Mala Buni	APC	Kanuri	OPHK Sector 2 (Damaturu); 120 Task Force Bn (Gujba); 159 Bn (Geidam); task-force brigade elements (Buni Yadi axis)
Adamawa	Ahmadu Umaru Fintiri	APC (defected from PDP, Feb 2026)	Northern-Adamawa minority (Madagali axis); identification varies in public reporting	23 Bde (Yola); OPHK Sector 4 (Adamawa) with newly inducted 226 Bn, operating with an Office of the NSA tactical team; NEW: 247 Recce Bn (stop-and-search logistics intercept). WATCH: Hong / Kopre Mountain / Mandara-fringe axis as a JAS rear area and suspected hostage-holding area
Bauchi	Bala Mohammed	PDP (opposition)	Fulani	33 Artillery Bde (Shadawanka Barracks, Bauchi)
Gombe	Muhammadu Inuwa Yahaya	APC	Fulani	Rear-area/support elements to OPHK
Taraba	Agbu Kefas	APC (defection from PDP announced for Jan 2026)	Jukun	HQ 10 Div (Jalingo) — activated Jul 2026, GOC Maj Gen C. R. Nnebeife; 6 Bde (Jalingo); Op Whirl Stroke elements
NORTH WEST				
Kaduna	Uba Sani	APC	Hausa/Fulani	HQ 1 Div (Kaduna) — NEW: GOC named, Maj Gen Abubakar Sadique Muhammed Wase, 44th GOC and dual-hatted Comd Sector 1 JTF Op Fansan Yamma (in post since Aug 2025; previously unnamed in this annex); Nigerian Defence Academy; major NAF bases (Kaduna); 44 Nigerian Army Reference Hospital — helipad and Waidi Shaibu Critical Care Centre commissioned 25 Aug 2026 for air CASEVAC of wounded
Kano	Abba Kabir Yusuf	APC (defected from NNPP, 26 Jan 2026)	Hausa/Fulani	3 Bde (Kano)
Katsina	Dikko Umaru Radda	APC	Fulani	17 Bde (Katsina) — Op Fansan Yamma
Kebbi	Nasir Idris	APC	Fulani (Kauran Gwandu)	Elements under 8 Div AOR (Birnin Kebbi garrison)
Sokoto	Ahmed Aliyu	APC	Hausa/Fulani	HQ 8 Div (Sokoto) — Op Fansan Yamma; 28 Special Forces Bde (FOB Sifawa, FOB Shagari); 8 Div Strike Team; COAS Intervention Bn 7 and 8 Task Force Group Administration Bn under Sector 2 OPFY; NEW: 8

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				Guards Task Force (FOB Kware; FOB Denge Shuni — Lakurawa counter-logistics); 8 Div Garrison elements at FOB Tidibale and FOB Ghandi, Isa LGA — WATCH: simultaneous night attacks on FOB Tidibale and village 6 Sep, two gun trucks burned; Tambuwal insecurity protest 11 Sep
Zamfara	Dauda Lawal	APC (defected from PDP, Mar 2026)	Hausa	1 Bde (Gusau) incl. FOB Sabon-Gari (Kaura Namoda); OPFY Sector 2; NAF and Police Air Wing air operations (Yankuzo/Tsafe 7 Sep; Jangebe axis)
Jigawa	Umar Namadi	APC	Hausa/Fulani	Elements under 3 Bde (Kano) AOR
NORTH CENTRAL				
Plateau	Caleb Mutfwang	APC (defected from PDP, late 2025)	Mwaghavul	HQ 3 Armoured Div (Jos); Op ENDURING PEACE (OPEP) — Comd Maj Gen W. M. Dangana, sectors numbered 1–8 with sub-sectors; Special Task Force OPEP — COMMANDER POST STILL VACANT in public reporting three weeks after Brig Gen M. S. Sule left for 27 TF Bde; state-level Op Rainbow alongside; CAUTION (persists): reporting uses OPEP and Op SAFE HAVEN interchangeably for the same sectors — treat the two names as one AOR when routing a request — WATCH: 19 Sep state-wide intelligence alert on markets, churches and mining sites, followed by nine killed across Barkin Ladi and Riyom on 19–20 Sep
Benue	Hyacinth Alia	APC	Tiv	HQ 5 Div (Makurdi) — GOC Maj Gen Moses Gara, dual-hatted Comd Op Whirl Stroke (Jul 2026); OPWS Sector 2 (Guma); 11 Bde (Gboko); 72 Special Forces Bn (Makurdi); Operation Zenda (state-level); NAF Tactical Air Command HQ (Makurdi) — WATCH: Ayilamo, Logo LGA attacked again 10 Sep, 4 MOPOL and 7 civilians killed
Niger	Mohammed Umaru Bago	APC	Nupe	31 Artillery Bde (Minna); Army TRADOC (Minna); 29 Bde (Kainji) — WATCH: Lakurawa operational leadership assessed by ISS to be

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				based in Borgu LGA; Op Savannah Shield active in Mariga LGA this week
Kwara	AbdulRahman AbdulRazaq	APC	Yoruba (Ilorin)	HQ 9 Div (Ilorin) — GOC Maj Gen Yakubu Yahaya, dual-hatted Comd Op Savannah Shield (Jul 2026); Sobi Barracks garrison
Kogi	Ahmed Usman Ododo	APC	Ebira	Garrison elements (Lokoja); NEW: 12 Bde (Irekpeni Patrol Base, Adavi LGA); confluence-axis security ops; joint ops under 2 Div AOR (western Kogi)
Nasarawa	Abdullahi Sule	APC	Hausa	10 Bde (Lafia); NEW: 177 Guards Bn (FOB Mararaba Udege); Op Whirl Stroke elements (Lafia axis)
FCT Abuja	— (administered by FCT Minister Nyesom Wike)	APC-aligned (Wike ex-PDP)	Ikwerre (minister)	Guards Bde (Abuja); Defence HQ & Service HQs; NAF HQ
SOUTH EAST				
Abia	Alex Otti	Labour Party (opposition)	Igbo	14 Bde (Ohafia); 144 Bn (Aba South)
Anambra	Charles Soludo (re-elected Nov 2025)	APGA (opposition, APC-aligned)	Igbo	302 Artillery Regt (Onitsha); 15 Bde — established Jul 2026 under JTF South East / Op UDO KA; led the 15 and 22 Aug Anambra camp raids
Ebonyi	Francis Nwifuru	APC	Igbo	Elements under 82 Div AOR (Abakaliki); 24 Special Engineer Regt
Enugu	Peter Mbah	APC (defected from PDP)	Igbo	HQ 82 Composite Div (Enugu)
Imo	Hope Uzodinma	APC	Igbo	34 Artillery Bde (Obinze, Owerri) — WATCH: first anti-armour IED against troops in the SE inside the window, detonated under an MRAP on the Ihite Ukwa–Health Centre axis, Orsu LGA, 4 Sep; Orsu sits on the Imo–Anambra ESN seam next to the Ihiala axis
SOUTH SOUTH				
Rivers	Siminalayi Fubara (reinstated Sep 2025 after emergency rule)	APC (reported defection from PDP, Dec 2025)	Ijaw (Opobo/Nkoro)	HQ 6 Div (Port Harcourt); 6 Div Garrison — NEW Comd Brig Gen I. Sule (9 Sep), replacing Brig Gen A. A. Bello (to DHQ Operations); JTF Op Delta Safe (Sector 3); NNS Pathfinder
Bayelsa	Douye Diri	APC (defected from PDP, 2025)	Ijaw	16 Bde (Yenagoa)
Delta	Sheriff Oborevwori	APC (defected from PDP, May 2025)	Okpe (Urhobo)	63 Bde (Asaba) = HQ Sector 1 JTF South-South Op DELTA SAFE, Comd Brig Gen I. B. Buhari; 90 Amphibious Bn (Sapele); AHQ committee inspected

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				two proposed sites for 83 Div units in Oshimili North on 7 Sep — Delta lobbying for the formation
Edo	Monday Okpebholo (elected Sep 2024)	APC	Esan	CORRECTED: 83 Div — APPROVED Jul 2026, NOT YET ESTABLISHED; HQ designated Benin City, AOR Edo/Delta/Bayelsa, expected stand-up by Dec 2026; temporary facility in Benin City promised within two weeks (Sep 2026). 4 Bde (Benin City) — Op WHIRL PUNCH / Op RESCUE; 322 Army Regt (Ekpoma); Op MESA (Akoko-Edo forest belt) — Edo 1 → 2 on the heatmap this issue
Akwa Ibom	Umo Eno	APC (defected from PDP, 2025)	Ibibio	2 Bde (Uyo)
Cross River	Bassey Otu	APC	Efik	13 Bde (Calabar); Navy Eastern Command (Calabar) — anti-piracy / oil-theft offensive announced 21 Aug 2026, continuing
SOUTH WEST				
Lagos	Babajide Sanwo-Olu	APC	Yoruba	HQ 81 Div (Lagos); Navy Western Command
Ogun	Dapo Abiodun	APC	Yoruba	Elements under 81 Div AOR
Oyo	Seyi Makinde	PDP (opposition)	Yoruba	HQ 2 Div (Ibadan) — GOC Maj Gen Auwalu Mahmuda (Jul 2026); 2 Div Garrison — Comd Brig Gen E. Azenda (9 Sep); Operation BURST (joint police/military/state task force) — WATCH: the Op BURST joint security base on the Igbeti axis, Oorelope LGA, was assaulted with heavy weapons at 05:30–06:00 on 13 Sep, a patrol van and a building block destroyed, attackers driven into surrounding forest; attribution unconfirmed. Oyo 2 → 3 on the heatmap this issue
Osun	Ademola Adeleke (re-elected 15 Aug 2026 — second term)	Accord Party — left PDP Dec 2025; re-elected 15 Aug 2026 with 511,067 votes vs APC 444,815; an APC-defection rumour was denied by his camp in late August	Yoruba	Elements under 2 Div AOR
Ondo	Lucky Aiyedatiwa (elected Nov 2024)	APC	Yoruba (Ilaje)	32 Artillery Bde (Akure/Owena)
Ekiti	Biodun Oyebanji	APC	Yoruba	Elements under 2 Div AOR (Ado-Ekiti garrison)

Changes to watch: the Special Task Force Op ENDURING PEACE command vacancy in Plateau is now the most consequential unfilled post in this annex — three weeks open, in the state where the security situation deteriorated this week and where a state-wide threat alert is live. Watch for where the new 8 Brigade stands

up and under which division; the disclosure is a month overdue. The OPHK commander, Maj Gen Ibikunle Ajose, is now visibly in post and the first test of his approach will be whether deliberate air interdiction over the Tumbuns resumes and is announced, and whether strike authorities in the reported JAS ceasefire belt are clarified. The 83 Division siting contest between Edo and Delta remains unresolved and will determine where a new divisional headquarters, and eventually its aviation support requirement, appears on the western Niger Delta seam by year-end. Carried forward: the western corridor (29 Bde Kainji and 9 Div Ilorin, with Lakurawa leadership assessed to sit in Borgu) — Kainji also being where the newly delivered A-29 munitions land; the Hong / Kopre Mountain axis in Adamawa as a JAS rear area and suspected hostage-holding area; the Osun governor's party position and the Bauchi governor's defection rumours as the 2027 cycle warms; and the Plateau naming overlap for routing requests.

Reminder: This is open-source orientation only and is not a substitute for current in-theatre intelligence. Verify all specifics against your unit's authoritative reporting before acting on them operationally.